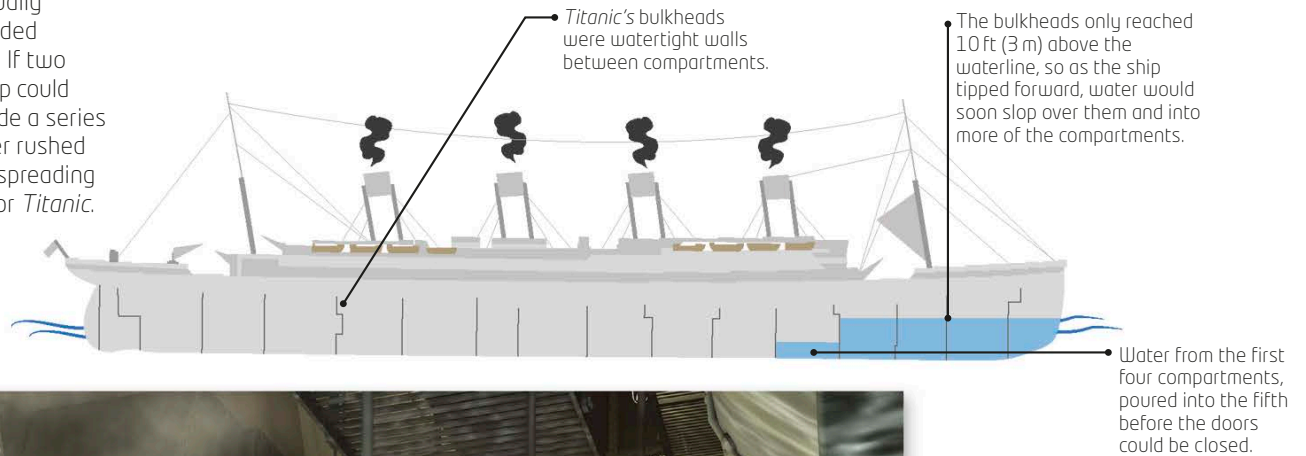


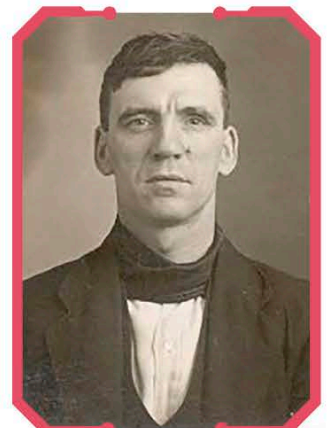
The sinking ship

Titanic was thought to be virtually unsinkable because it was divided into watertight compartments. If two compartments flooded, the ship could stay afloat. But the iceberg made a series of gashes in the ship and water rushed into four compartments, soon spreading to a fifth. This was too much for *Titanic*.



"Water came pouring in two feet above the [floor]; the ship's side was torn from the third [boiler room] to the forward end."

—Frederick William Barrett, Lead stoker



Frederick Barrett

Lead fireman Frederick Barrett was on duty in boiler room six when the collision happened. He escaped on Lifeboat 13, but it drifted under Lifeboat 15, which was being lowered into the sea. Barrett pushed his boat clear, saving many lives with his actions.

3 The water seeping up through the floor poses a deadly risk: if the boilers flood, so much steam will be produced that they might explode.

4 The crewmen have to work quickly to reduce the fires and vent the steam the boilers produce to reduce the chance of an explosion.

5 The engineer in charge of the team is sending updates to the captain up on the bridge.